



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Corporate Communications Network Internal Communications WhatsApp Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS POLICY

PROCEDURES FOR THE USE OF WHATSAPP MESSAGING AS AN INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS TOOL WITHIN THE JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

PRODUCED BY THE CONSTABULARY COMMUNICATIONS NETWORK (CCN)

CONTENT

Purpose	3
Overview	4
Guidelines/SOP	5

PURPOSE

The purpose of this document is to establish the Jamaica Constabulary Force's policy relating to the use of the WhatsApp Messaging platform as an internal communications tool. It describes procedures and responsibilities for use by members, whose Senior Officers have authorised the creation and utilisation of WhatsApp as a group communications channel within their Divisions and Formations.

This document does not operate in isolation as it further supports the Force's Policy Framework as it relates to Internal Communications, Media Relations and Social Media.

All users are being advised that this platform does not in any way replace, nor is a substitute for the formal communication process of the JCF which requires written, signed documents as is appropriate.

OVERVIEW

In this fast paced mobile central world, it is important for organisations to embrace technologies that allow their employees to interact in a multiplicity of ways via their smart devices - whether that may be through video links, voice notes or instant messaging. Used carefully and responsibly, apps with such capabilities will allow staff to access and process the right information, at the right time.

WhatsApp Messenger is a cross-platform mobile messaging app which allows users to exchange messages without having to pay for SMS. WhatsApp Messenger is available for iPhone, BlackBerry, Android, Windows Phone and Nokia.

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF), with its dynamic and diverse membership and its far-reaching national impact, has the perfect candidate profile for employing the use of WhatsApp as an Internal Communications tool.

The use of WhatsApp within the JCF can significantly help the process of knowledge sharing, keeping everyone connected, on track with the organisation's operations and on point with key messaging. Messages are sent and viewed in a quick timespan, as does corresponding actions. It provides direct and effective person-person communication by facilitating:

1. Real time chats
2. Multimedia sharing
3. Communication with groups of up to 100 persons

The addition of this app to the organisation's suite of internal communications tools will therefore strengthen its 'inside voice', while supporting the 2016 Communications Mandate of 'Managing the Conversations'.

**GUIDELINES/SOP FOR WHATSAPP USE
AS AN INTERNAL COMMUNICATIONS TOOL WITHIN THE JCF**

1. Security

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 1.1 Be mindful of fiercely protecting the JCF, its reputation, information and sources when utilising WhatsApp or any other instant messaging app, social media app or communications software.
- 1.2 Take extreme care in crafting and sharing messages for WhatsApp distribution, keeping in mind the type or level of information, and with whom information is shared. There are oftentimes matters sensitive to investigations or operations which cannot and should not be divulged to a wider audience, and as such care must be taken to apply the most appropriate communication medium for information dissemination.
- 1.3 Be aware that WhatsApp's Terms of Service relates that there is no guarantee that conversations are private and confidential. Of equal importance is that conversations had via this app will not be erased; instead they are stored in WhatsApp's database. One must also be cognisant that WhatsApp is susceptible to hacking as it's been found that its privacy levels are among the poorest of messaging applications.

2. Personal vs. Work-Assigned WhatsApp Number

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 2.1 Take care when using their personal cellular number as the number for their professional WhatsApp group, ensuring that personal issues are not inadvertently transmitted to the work group. If possible, it is advised that users have dedicated personal and professional WhatsApp numbers, even if one phone instrument is being used.

3. Professional Name

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 3.1 Use their correct names at all times. This name is visible to all group members so aliases are not acceptable.
- 3.2 Use their full names to avoid further confusion within the group – especially if it is a large group, where multiple users may have the same first or surnames or a similar sequence of initials. For instance, ‘Tom Brown’ should be used instead of ‘T.B.’ or ‘T. Brown’.

4. Professional Image

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 4.1 Not use a photo or image that may be deemed to be offensive or unprofessional as their WhatsApp profile photo. It is strongly advised that a portrait photo of the member or an appropriate work-related image is used.
- 4.2 Take care to use a portrait photo that is clear and offers no visual encumbrances

5. Respectful Exchange

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 5.1 At all times appropriately greet their group members, using words such as ‘Good Morning/Afternoon/Evening/Night’, ‘Hello’, or even ‘Greetings’, followed by the person’s rank and/or name. It is strongly advised against using local parlance such as ‘Yow’, ‘Mi Dupes’ or any similar local phrase.
- 5.2 Share information and have discussions in respectful tones.
- 5.3 Not devalue another member’s contributions to the discussions in an open forum, creating an environment of embarrassment and hostility.
- 5.4 Refrain from sending WhatsApp messages in all caps, as these are often perceived to be shouting and will likely illicit unexpected or unwanted responses.
- 5.5 Respond using complete sentences that show an interest in and understanding of the topic at hand. It will be considered bad-mannered and offensive to give one word responses such as ‘K’.

6. Information Sharing

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 6.1 Maintain professionalism in every interaction with members of the Group.
- 6.2 Limit the sharing of jokes or comical memes via this medium. If humorous content is to be shared, the sender takes full responsibility to ensure it is in good taste and not likely to be viewed as malicious, harassing or crude.
- 6.2 Not share sensitive information that would compromise the organisation or specific operations, keeping in mind WhatsApp's privacy limitations.

7. Message length

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 7.1 Be careful to not send too long messages via WhatsApp. Your audience should be able to be read and understand quickly. For longer messages, include a link or reference an email.

8. Photos and Videos

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 8.1 Always double check to ensure that any photo or video being shared is appropriate and that the content is received by the intended audience.
- 8.2 Be mindful of the size of the file being shared. Do not send data that is too large it may take a while for recipients to download, or which may clog their storage. Send large files via email or a file-sharing site such as www.sendspace.com

9. Use of Emoticons

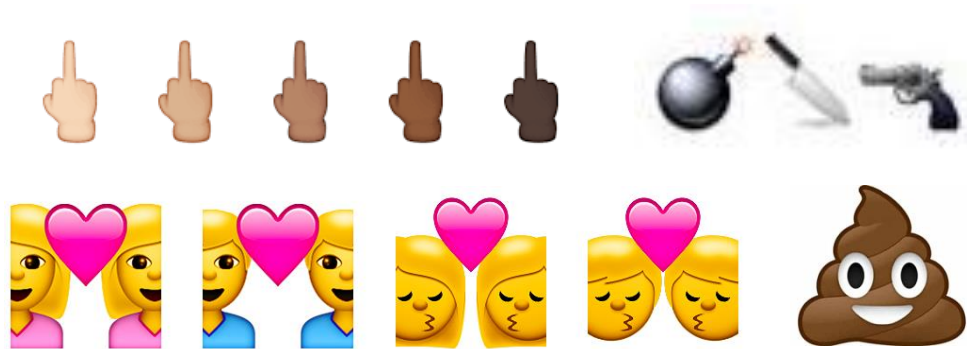
Emoticons can enhance the accuracy of emotional perception during an instant messaging conversation. Not hearing the tonality of someone's voice, messages can be misinterpreted as happy, angry or even sarcastic, when that was not the sender's intent.

With this in mind, members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 9.1 Watch the frequency of emoticon use. Not every statement needs to be punctuated with a Smiley.
- 9.2 Refrain from using emoticons at all, until one better understands the members of your group.
- 9.3 Be mindful that typically acceptable emoticons include Smileys, Thumbs Up, Thumbs Down, High Five or Clap. Unacceptable ones which can be easily

misinterpreted in a professional group include Smileys with Love, Kisses or Lips, Romantic Gestures etc.

- 9.4 Be fully aware of global and cultural trends that may influence members' interpretation of some emoticons as offensive, and care must be taken to refrain from use. These include:



- 9.5 Take care to not use ambiguous emoticons. For instance, during emotionally-charged Political periods, it may be wise to refrain from hand signals (such as the below). While the sender could mean 'Peace' for the two-finger emoticon and 'Respect' or 'Agreement' for the fist bump, these could also be easily interpreted as showing support for political parties that incorporate these signals as part of their brand.



- 9.6 Not use symbols that communicate another language. If you or your recipient/s do not understand same, do not use symbols such as:



9.7 Have an understanding of the meanings of the basic Smiley Faces as follows:



HAPPY FACE
WITH WIDE
MOUTH AND
SQUINTING
EYES



RELIEVED
FACE



FACE WITH
HEART
SHAPED EYES



SMIRKING
FACE



GRIMMACING
FACE



WINKING
FACE WITH
STUCK OUT
TONGUE



FACE WITH
STUCK OUT
TONGUE AND
EYES CLOSED



DISAPPOINTED
FACE



KISSING FACE
WITH CLOSED
EYES



HAPPY AND
CRYING FACE



SLEEPY FACE



FACE WITH
COLD SWEAT



LOUDLY
CRYING FACE



HAPPY FACE
WITH OPEN
MOUTH



HAPPY FACE
WITH OPEN
MOUTH AND
SQUINTING
EYES



WINKING
FACE



EXPRESSION-
LESS FACE



PERSON
FROWNING



CONFOUNDED
FACE



FACE
THROWING A
KISS



ANGRY FACE



POUTING
FACE



CRYING FACE



TIRED FACE



DISAPPOINTED
BUT
RELIEVED
FACE



FEARFUL
FACE



EXASPERATED
FACE



FACE
SCREAMING
IN FEAR



ASTONISHED
FACE



FLUSHED
FACE

10. Use of Proper English and Acronyms

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 10.1 Use discernable, grammatically-correct words and phrases and JCF-accepted acronyms that are known and understood by all, during all interaction within the group. Shortened version of words such as 'ck' for 'check', 'lk' for 'look', 'K' for 'OK' etc. will not be accepted. Write full sentences that may leave no room for misinterpretation.
- 10.2 Use only some popular acronyms, such as LOL (Laugh out loud), FYI (For your information) and BTW (By the way).
- 10.3 Be mindful to not inject Jamaican-specific social media acronyms such as 'DWRCL' when communicating in your professional WhatsApp group. It is equally unacceptable to use curse words or phrases, such as 'OMFG' or 'STFU'.

11. Response Time

Members of a JCF work-based WhatsApp Group shall:

- 11.1 Understand that WhatsApp messages are real time conversations, so it's important to respond within a few minutes of having received and read a message. If a fulsome response cannot be given at the time, at least acknowledge receipt with the commitment to give more details at a later time.